xiii. Oils and fats need special attention in storage because they tend to get rancid in the presence of light. So fats and oils should be stored in a place where it can be protected from sunlight.

If foods are not stored properly they can become contaminated leading to several health hazards.



3.4 Food Adulteration

Adulteration of food stuffs is commonly practised in India by the traders. When the price of food production is higher than the price which the consumer is prepared to pay, the seller is compelled to supply a food product of inferior quality. Thus, adulteration occurs.

Definition: Adulteration is defined as the process by which the quality or the nature of a given substance is reduced through i) addition of a foreign or an inferior substance and the ii) removal of a vital element.

Adulterants can be of two types

1) **Intentional Adulterants:** Some manufacturers mix adulterants like brick powder, chalk powder, dried seeds, stones, marble, addition of harmful colors to food items like spices, pulses (metanil yellow in Turmeric or Carmoisine in Chili powder) with intention to make more profit.
2) **Incidental Adulterants** is the contamination due to carelessness and lack of proper hygiene during overall processing of food. It includes contamination due to defective packaging and storage and may result in bacterial or fungal attack.

As adulteration is rampant everywhere, consumer should be aware of adulterators and one should take steps to safeguard themselves against those food items. It is as shown in the table 3.4.1.





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